



Key HR initiatives

▶ HUL's Open2U is a platform that gives expert talent and gig workers an opportunity to work on strategic projects, but with the security of a full-time job. The company uses this policy to get experts for special projects on a short-term basis

▶ Under U-Work, HUL employees don't have one single

role. They are part of diverse assignments and also enjoy the freedom to pursue personal endeavours between projects. They also receive a monthly retainer

▶ HUL has a foster/kinship caregiver leave policy, with the aim to prioritise all forms of caregiving, without making a distinction. Under

this, employees who are caregivers for foster children or kinship have a range of support systems available

▶ HUL, which has witnessed the FMCG market grow and change drastically, also has robust skill-building and reskilling avenues available for its employees

across levels," she says. Apart from upskilling, Razdan says that a key aspect of leadership grooming is also dependent upon the work culture. And HUL prides itself in being an open and nurturing space. Also, working for a large multinational has its own advantages and being relocated to different markets is one. "The international experience is of great importance and a key part of the overall leadership grooming process," she says.

Similarly, HUL prides itself in

being a gender-diverse organisation. According to Razdan, women account for 46.5% of managerial positions. That number was just 4% in 1999. And like its multiple businesses, there are many layers to HUL. This March, the company introduced the foster/kinship caregiver leave policy.

"By pioneering this initiative, we aim to create a supportive ecosystem that values all forms of caregiving," says Razdan. In addition to offering a range of parental

support options—parental leave, adoption leave, secondary caregiver leave—the recent initiative is "a step forward to ensure caregivers for foster children or kinship can balance their professional responsibilities with their caregiving duties".

In line with making jobs flexible, both in terms of schedule and place of work, HUL has two policies: Open2U and U-Work. Open2U is a platform that allows expert talent/gig workers the opportunity to work on strategic projects with the security and benefits of a full-time job. "We primarily use this to get experts in for special projects on a short-term basis," she explains.

In the case of U-Work, HUL employees enjoy the best of both worlds: the autonomy of contract positions paired with the stability and perks commonly found in traditional employment. Under this, individuals aren't confined to a single role; they engage in diverse assignments and enjoy the freedom to pursue personal endeavours between projects. Regardless of their current workload, they receive a monthly retainer along with a tailored package of benefits.

HUL, which has consistently been among the top names in BT-Tagg's The Best Companies to Work For in India lists, remains a coveted destination for aspiring managers. But, it doesn't dwell on past success. In an ever-evolving market, strategic refinement is crucial. Central to this evolution is cultivating a positive work culture—essential for sustained growth.

And HUL aims to underscore this vital message. "We need to be viewed as a company that not just does well but does good too," says Razdan. **BT**

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